

TOPIC: *Many people believe that formal "pen and paper" examinations are not the best method of assessing educational achievement.*

What is your view of examinations?

Give reasons for your answer and include any relevant examples from your own knowledge or experience.

It is undeniable that the "pen and paper" examinations are really classical and popular throughout the world. Nowadays, there are a variety of methods of assessing educational achievement resulting in a comparison that some people think those examinations are not the best method. In my opinion, I argue that this view is right.

Exactly, the "pen and paper" examinations have a few clear benefits. For example, it helps students improve their writing, reading skill and abilities of analyzing, summarizing data for the answers. Furthermore, this method is really easy to implement with some simple equipment and preparation such as pens, pencils and papers. This experience can be found easily by pupils, students once they used to go to school. On the other hand, this kind of examination is quite popular and appropriate for many different ages.

However, with the creativity of awareness and technology, there are many kinds of examination such as interview, survey, presentation, outdoor activities. Once the "pen and paper" examinations are not the most popular method any longer, there is a certain comparison among those methods. It is true that, this traditional method has a few disadvantages. For instance, it is quite hard to link between the examinations and reality whereas an interview can do it well. For example, students can have some bad behaviors once making the "pen and paper" examinations, they hardly do the same actions when attending an outdoor activities or presentation in front of many people. Therefore, each method has both advantages and disadvantages, it is so hard to find the best method.

In conclusion, I fully believe that over time, the "pen and paper" examinations are not the best way to assess the educational achievement because of its negative

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effects. We have to take advantage of its and others' benefits in order to have good assessment in education. (306 words).



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TOPIC: *Convenience foods will become increasingly prevalent and eventually replace traditional foods and traditional methods of food preparation.*

To what extent do you agree or disagree with this opinion?

Give reasons for your answer and include any relevant examples from your own knowledge or experience.

It cannot be denied that convenience foods are really convenient and becoming one of the most preferences of many people for their meals. The appearance of McDonalds, KFC, Lotteria are making some people believe that fast foods will increasingly prevalent and replace traditional foods as well as traditional cuisines. In my opinion, I do not agree with that argument.

First of all, it is necessary to take this issue into consideration that which customers always use fast food and the reasons they use. For example, some people who are so busy working, studying that they have difficulty enjoying a common meal. On the other hand, simply, they very keen on eating them. Others still prefer traditional foods to fast foods which have made themselves become one of the countries' landmarks, such as *pho* in Vietnam, *ca ri* in India, *kim chi* in Korea. Therefore, not at all people eat convenience foods, it is not easy to replace traditional foods despite this increasing prevalence.

It is true that the traditional foods and cuisines contain many beneficial nutrition ingredients that the fast foods do not have. This reason can make many people change their preference. For instance, parents believe that a complete meal with traditional foods can be a bit better than convenience foods for their children. Especially, nutritionists usually advise many people to avoid fast foods as much as possible for a good health.

Finally, conservation of traditional foods and traditional methods of food preparation is really important as for countries throughout the world. Although convenience foods are become increasingly prevalent, traditional foods must be maintained because of benefits related to countries' reputation, economic values and other advantages.

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In conclusion, nowadays, it is admitted that the fast foods' popularity is inevitable. However, it is so hard for them to replace traditional foods and cuisines. (303 words).



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TOPIC: *Women and men are commonly seen as having different strengths and weaknesses. Is it right to exclude males or females from certain professions because of their gender?*

Give reasons for your answer and include any relevant examples from your own knowledge or experience.

It is undeniable that women and men have differences in strengths and weaknesses which affect their opportunities in choosing certain professions. Some people think that it is necessary for women and men to be considered kinds of jobs because of their gender. In my view, that idea is not right.

Nowadays, in the modern societies, it is not hard to find the gender equality in recruitment at many companies. Many employers prefer to hire eligible employees without considering their gender as long as the candidates can prove their abilities. For example, they list requirements for the certain positions which the applicants have to meet in order to be hired. This trend can be easily found in the recruiting culture in the Western's countries.

On the other hand, although women and men have differences in strengths and weaknesses, there are many special situations. For instance, many male labors can take charge of female labors' tasks and vice versa. Nowadays, it is easy to find many important positions in societies which are assumed by women such as Mrs. Merkel (Germany's Prime Ministry) or Mrs. Theresa May (the UK's Prime Ministry). Their abilities and successes are admitted by people all over the world.

Another reason demonstrates the reason why it is not right to exclude males and females from certain professions owing to their gender, it is difficulties for the recruiters in choosing candidates. Indeed, once there is discrimination in that, many companies have difficulties considering whether male or female is suitable for the certain positions without taking their individual abilities into account. It is undeniable that there have been many selected candidates because of their gender instead of their fulfillment in jobs.

In conclusion, women and men should be considered in assuming the professions by whether they can meet the recruiter's requirements or not. In my

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opinion, excluding them from the jobs because of their gender is not right.
(324 words).



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TOPIC: *As languages such as English, Spanish and Mandarin become more widely spoken, there is a fear that many minority languages may die out.*

Some countries have taken steps to protect minority languages.

What is your view of this practice?

Give reasons for your answer and include any relevant examples from your own knowledge or experience.

According to an unofficial survey of the popularity of the widely spoken languages throughout the world, English, Chinese, Spanish and Arabian are the most popular languages, nowadays. However, there is a negative effect resulting from this reality that many minority languages may disappear and some countries have made effort to protect them from the danger. In my opinion, it is necessary to do this, as soon as possible.

It is undeniable that English and other widely spoken languages are becoming so popular that many people can easily find in many fields such as communication, business, human resources. For example, in international trade business environment in recent years, English has been used really widely not only in writing (contracts) but also in spoken materials (negotiation). Furthermore, in order to recruit global staff, many companies prefer to choose ability of speaking English, Chinese, Spanish as a basic requirement. In this current economy, the better people are aware of the most popular languages, the more successful they will be in their career and life.

However, the popularity in using languages is causing the minority languages to be in danger of extinction. In order to resolve this consequence which can affect negatively into culture, freedom in languages and nationality, it is necessary to protect them. For instance, the languages of Africa countries are really less popular than others. However, they are the unique features of them. It is so hard to ignore the danger for the minority languages because of their importance in the world's culture. It is dangerous once the current minority languages disappear resulting in the loss of freedom and nationality of many countries.

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In conclusion, it is really important to protect the minority languages from the popularity of the widely spoken languages. In my mind, this is a mission many governments have to constantly implement in the coming time. (307 words).



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